

Adding effects to your home videos that can make the videos look professional, and make you look good

Jayesh Limaye

So you've finally managed to store the memorable videos you captured during your holidays last year. And now you even have it on your computer's hard drive. What next?

You could add some transition effects to your videos to give it a professional feel.

You might have frantically searched the Internet looking for tools that might let you do this, and probably found that everything available is either shareware, or whatever is freeware, has very few features.

Most of you might not be aware that Ahead, the makers of Nero Burning ROM, has developed a tool—NeroVision Express 3—that lets you do all the editing you want.

NeroVision Express 3 can also be downloaded from <http://nero.com>, where it is also updated quite frequently.

This utility not only supports adding transition effects to captured video, but also lets you capture video using your TV tuner card, video capture devices and DV cams.

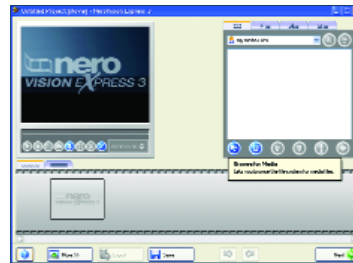
1 STEP To start off, open NeroVision Express from the Nero program group. Now, click on 'Make



Nero Version Express 3

Movie', located on the left of the window.

2 STEP A new 'Untitled Project' window will open up. In this window, you will have a preview pane on the left, while on the right, you will be able to view the 'My Media' files, in which the videos selected by you for the addition of transition effects

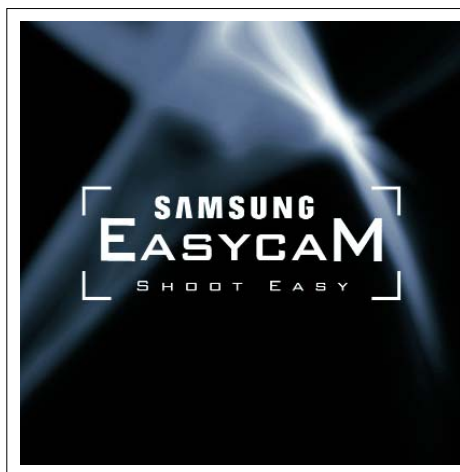


Movie Project Window

are listed. The area at the bottom are the 'Storyboard' and 'Timeline' areas, where you will be able to monitor how your video progresses.

While 'Storyboard' displays the videos and transitions you are using, the video effects, text effects and audio items can only be added to the 'Timeline' view.

In the 'Storyline' view, these items appear as symbols below the video.



3 STEP Click on the first blue button below the 'My Media' files to browse and select the video clips to be added to the compilation. A browsing window will be opened and you may choose as many video clips as you want. Now, just click 'Open'. Almost all popular video formats—except Real Media—are



Movie Project Window after choosing video clips



Scene Detection Window



Detected scenes are displayed

supported. The video clips added will be visible in the 'My Media Files' list.

4 STEP For transition effects to be added, you need multiple clips to add transitions in between. Hence, it is recommended to have as many clips as possible. But, if all your videos are just one file, you can also insert transition effects into the video. Right-click on the video in the 'My Media Files' list and click on 'Detect Scenes'. Scenes will then be automatically detected and displayed.

5 STEP Detected scenes can be added to the project by dragging and dropping them to the 'Storyboard' and 'Timeline' areas.

Then, click on the 'Display Transition' tab, which is the last tab above 'My Media' files.

Here, you will find a host of transition effects, which are further classified into 3D, Wipes, Others and Fades.

3D effects consist of many three-dimensional effects such as Exploding Cubes, Horizontal Spinning Strokes, Spherise, Tunnelise, and so on.

'Wipes', as the name suggests, consists of several wipe effects such as Circles, MeltDown, Paper Roll, Wipe Left, Right, Up or Down, etc.

'Others' has Move In and Move Out while 'Fades' consists